



• THE OFFICIAL •

Jobs-To-Be-Done Playbook

TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY THROUGH INNOVATION ↗

FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN ↗

BECOME A CLIENT ↗

Many people aspire to be **great innovators** — to build and launch hugely successful products and be known as leaders in their industries.

But depending on your source, ***between 70% and 95% of all new products fail. Statistically speaking, your product is going to flop.***

The reason so many innovators fail and so many products flop is that innovators don't really understand what it is their customers want. Moreover, they don't know what inputs they need from customers to make innovation predictable.

The reason so many innovators fail and so many products flop is that innovators don't really understand what it is their customers want. Moreover, they don't know what inputs they need from customers to make innovation predictable.

The team at Arm & Hammer's Animal Nutrition business was all too familiar with this challenge. Despite the technical success of their products, the business had suffered through several disappointing product development efforts and launches over the course of several years. Although they had been relying on industry-leading consultants to provide the insights to drive their innovation process, the commercial response to these innovations was lackluster.

Fortunately, all Arm & Hammer needed was a *new perspective*.

They needed

Jobs-to-be-done. ↗

Jobs-to-be-Done is best defined as a perspective — a lens through which you can observe markets, customers, needs, competitors, and customer segments differently, and by doing so, make innovation far more predictable and profitable.

Jobs-to-be-Done helps **product managers** to:

- Conceptualize new products
- Improve existing products
- Prioritize product backlog
- Create a product roadmap
- Design a user experience
- Validate the potential of an offering before development begins

Are you a **marketing manager**? Jobs-to-be-Done can help you:

- Craft a value proposition that connects with customers
- Communicate competitive strengths
- Craft sales pitches that convert
- Design web pages and campaigns that convert
- Create content that attracts leads

Executive leaders appreciate how Jobs-to-be-Done helps them:

- Align the organization around a common vision
- Achieve a shared understanding of customer needs across the organization
- Determine which firms to acquire and partner with
- Discover new markets to enter
- Adopt innovation practices that lead to greater success

This playbook will teach you the tenets of Jobs-to-be-Done and how to apply them in your own organization, whatever your position — just like Arm & Hammer did to grow year-over-year revenue by more than 30%.

Or like Microsoft did to **turn around a flailing business and double revenue.** ↗

And how Bosch entered a new market with a **top-selling and top-rated circular saw.** ↗

Or how Cox Automotive **increased its product install base by 20X.** ↗

You get the picture.

ARE YOU READY TO SEE RESULTS LIKE THESE FOR YOUR OWN BUSINESS?

THEN IT'S TIME TO DIVE INTO **JOBS-TO-BE-DONE**

CHAPTER 01	What is Jobs-to-be-Done?	1
CHAPTER 02	Define Your Market	9
CHAPTER 03	Build Your Job Map & Visualize What Your Customers Want	18
CHAPTER 04	Product, Marketing, & Executives put JTBD into Practice	31



TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY
THROUGH INNOVATION ↗

FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN ↗

BECOME A CLIENT ↗

CHAPTER
01

What is Jobs-to-be-Done?

Jobs-to-be-Done is best defined as a perspective — a new lens through which you can observe markets, customers, needs, competitors, and customer segments more insightfully.



TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY
THROUGH INNOVATION ↗

FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN ↗

BECOME A CLIENT ↗

When you look at marketing and innovation through a Jobs-to-be-Done lens, everything looks different:

- The unit of analysis is no longer the customer or the product. It's the "job" the customer is trying to get done.
- Markets aren't defined around products. They are defined as groups of people trying to get a job done.
- Customers aren't just buyers. They also include job executors.
- Needs aren't vague, latent and unknowable. They are the metrics customers use to measure success when getting a job done.
- Competitors aren't companies that make products like yours. They are companies with any solution people use to get the job done.
- Customer segments aren't based on demographics or psychographics. They are based on how customers struggle differently to get a job done.

When you think about your market from this perspective, you are much more likely to create and deliver extraordinary products and services.

Why?

Products come and go, but the customer's job-to-be-done is stable over time. With a stable unit of analysis, you can define customer needs that are stable over time, too, which gives you unique, robust targets for value creation.

In short, using a Jobs-to-be-Done lens, you can take your understanding of customer needs to the next level. And with the right customer inputs, you can orchestrate the systematic creation of customer value across the organization.

This chapter explains nine tenets of Jobs-to-be-Done Theory and prepares you for applying these tenets to grow your own business. You'll also find out how Arm & Hammer used these tenets to turn around a streak of lackluster product launches — and grow 30%+ year-over-year.



TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY
THROUGH INNOVATION ↗

FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN ↗

BECOME A CLIENT ↗

What is Jobs-to-be-Done Theory?

When looking at marketing and innovation through a jobs-to-be-done lens, a theory begins to emerge.

Jobs to be Done theory consists of a group of principles or tenets that form a foundation for making marketing more effective and innovation more predictable by focusing on the customer's job-to-be-done.

The theory is based on the notion that people buy products and services to get a "job" done. Jobs Theory goes on to say that by understanding in detail what that "job" entails, you are far more likely to create and market solutions that will win in the marketplace.

You can confidently rely on these nine tenets as the building blocks for predictable growth:

- 01** People buy products and services to get a "job" done.
- 02** Jobs are functional—with emotional and social components.
- 03** A Job-to-be-Done is stable over time.
- 04** A Job-to-be-Done is solution agnostic.
- 05** Success comes from making the job the unit of analysis, rather than the product or the customer.
- 06** A deep understanding of the customer's job makes marketing more effective — and innovation far more predictable.
- 07** Innovation becomes predictable when "needs" are defined as the metrics customers use to measure success when getting the job done.
- 08** People want products and services that will help them get a job done better and/or more cheaply.
- 09** People seek out products and services that enable them to get the entire job done on a single platform.

Each of these tenets brings new insights into your company's business practices — increasing the organization's ability to create and market breakthrough products and services. **Let's look at each in more detail.**

TENET

01

People buy products and services to get a “job” done.

People have underlying problems they are trying to resolve. They have goals they are trying to achieve and tasks and activities they are trying to complete. They may be faced with situations they are trying to avoid. In each of these cases, people often turn to products and services to help them get a “job” done.

A job is not a description of what the customer is doing, the solution they are using, or the steps they are taking to get a job done. Rather, the job is what the customer is ultimately trying to accomplish. **The core job-to-be-done is defined as a “functional job.”**

With this in mind, you can define your market as a group of people and the functional job they are trying to get done.

For example:

- **Parents** (a group of people) who are trying to **“pass on life lessons to children”** (the functional job-to-be-done) constitute a market.
- **Surgeons** (a group of people) who are trying to **“repair a torn rotator cuff”** (the functional job-to-be-done) constitute a market.
- **Music enthusiasts** (a group of people) who are trying to **“listen to music”** (the functional job-to-be-done) constitute a market.

When you define a market this way, you clarify your target customer and the job you are going to help the customer accomplish with your product or service offering

TENET

02

**Jobs are functional—
with emotional and
social components.**

As a customer uses a product or service to get a functional job done, they often want to feel a certain way or be perceived in a certain light by their peers, friends or others. The ways they want to feel and be perceived are called emotional and social jobs-to-be-done.

For example, when parents are trying to pass on life lessons to children (the functional job-to-be-done), they may also want to feel like they are contributing to the advancement of society or want to be perceived as good parents by their peers.

Understanding the emotional and social components of the functional job brings rich insights that can lead to the creation of a value proposition that highly resonates with customers — at both a functional and emotional level.



TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY
THROUGH INNOVATION ↗

FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN ↗

BECOME A CLIENT ↗

TENET

03

A Job-to-be-Done is stable over time.

A functional job-to-be-done is often something people have been trying to accomplish for years, decades—or even centuries. Parents, for example, have been trying to pass on life lessons to children since the beginning of humanity.

A functional job is stable over time.

What changes are the products and services that companies offer to help get the job done better.

Because the job-to-be-done is stable over time, it is an attractive focal point around which to create customer value for many years. With this in mind, your business' strategy should always be to help customers get the entire job done better and more cheaply on a single product platform. This is the long-term strategy that Amazon has pursued since its inception.

TENET

04

A Job-to-be-Done is solution agnostic.

The core functional job is solution agnostic—this means it is independent of any solutions or technologies.

Innovation isn't about "a faster horse." A "horse" is a solution to get a job done. The job (transporting yourself from point A to point B) must be defined independently of the solution (the horse). This is how new, breakthrough solutions can be conceptualized (like the automobile).

Customers don't know what solutions will get a job done best— they couldn't envision the car or the microwave or the smartphone. **But customers do know what job they are trying to get done and can tell you all about it.**

Lastly, since the job-to-be-done is solution agnostic, competitors are not only companies that make products like yours. They are any solution (paid and non-paid) that customers use to get the core job done. For example, the bicycle and the car are competing solutions for the job of getting from point a to point b.



TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY
THROUGH INNOVATION ↗

FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN ↗

BECOME A CLIENT ↗

TENET
05**Success comes from making the job the unit of analysis, rather than the product or the customer.**

Making the job-to-be-done the unit of analysis means it is the job — not the product, the customer, the circumstance, the purchase process or customer demographics — that you need to study, dissect and understand at a granular level of detail.

Henry Ford said it best, “If I had asked people what they wanted, they would have said a faster horse.” The point Ford is making is that innovators cannot simply ask customers what solutions they want, because customers rarely know — and why should they? They are not engineers, scientists and technologists. We cannot expect them to tell us the solution.

That’s why as innovators we must change the unit of analysis when talking to customers. While they often do not know what solutions will best satisfy their needs, customers do know what they are trying to accomplish as it relates to getting a job done. They know what aspects of the job are time consuming, unpredictable and ineffective. They can define their needs around the job-to-be-done.

With a focus on the customer’s job-to-be-done, you are able to:

1. Identify where and why customers are struggling to get the job done.
2. Brainstorm ideas for new offerings
3. Determine in advance of development which ideas will help customers get the job done best.

When you define a market this way, you clarify your target customer and the job you are going to help the customer accomplish with your product or service offering

TENET
06**A deep understanding of the customer’s job makes marketing more effective — and innovation far more predictable.**

A deep understanding of the customer’s job makes marketing more effective — and innovation far more predictable.

The fundamentals of marketing and innovation are straightforward.

If your team can agree on what a customer need is, what the customer’s needs are, and which customer needs are unmet or underserved, **you are able to:**

1. Better position and sell more of the company’s existing products.
2. Improve existing products and services.
3. Create new products and services.

Jobs-to-be-Done Theory makes this possible.

With a deep understanding of the customer’s needs for any given job, you can finally know—maybe for the first time—all of the customer’s needs. This is truly transformational as most product teams (and most VoC practitioners) don’t even agree on what a need is and end up using customer inputs that derail the innovation process.



TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY
THROUGH INNOVATION ↗

FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN ↗

BECOME A CLIENT ↗

TENET

07

Innovation becomes predictable when “needs” are defined as the metrics customers use to measure success when getting the job done.

Innovation becomes predictable when “needs” are defined as the metrics customers use to measure success when getting the job done.

In order to determine if your new product idea will help a customer get a job done better and/or more cheaply, you must be able to evaluate competing ideas against a stable set of metrics.

The metrics we use to conduct this evaluation are the customer’s desired outcomes. In other words, we define customer needs (desired outcomes) as the metrics that customers use to measure success when getting the job done. These metrics are extracted from customers through customer interviews. Customers typically use between 50 and 150 metrics to explain the successful execution of the job. Capturing all of them is the key to success.

Since the customer’s job-to-be-done is stable over time, the customer’s needs, when defined as desired outcome statements, are also stable over time. **With a stable set of “needs” in hand, you can:**

- Quantify which needs are underserved and overserved.
- Discover segments of customers with different unmet needs.
- Use the metrics as a baseline against which you can test product ideas and concepts before they are developed.

TENET

08

People want products and services that will help them get a job done better and/or more cheaply.

We have learned that people aren’t loyal to companies or brands.

They are loyal to getting a job done better (faster, more predictably, and with higher output/throughput) and/or more cheaply. They replace existing products and services with those that help them achieve these goals.

We have learned that some people are willing to pay more to get a job done better, while others are willing to pay less to get a job done worse. Knowing what types of customers exist in your market (and in what proportions) forms the foundation for a new way to think about your growth strategy.

The possibilities are highlighted here in the Jobs-to-be-Done Growth Strategy Matrix:



TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY
THROUGH INNOVATION ↗

FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN ↗

BECOME A CLIENT ↗

People seek out products and services that enable them to get the entire job done on a single platform.

There are many products and services available in the market that only get part of a job done.

Customers are left to cobble together solutions in order to get the entire job done. But customers don't want to cobble together the solution. They want a complete solution presented to them.

Your goal should therefore always be to help your customers get their entire job done on a single platform. And you can accelerate this process once you know exactly what steps the customer goes through to complete the job.

Nespresso is a great example. The company worked for years with a single strategy in mind: to enable customers to get the job of "preparing a hot beverage for consumption" done on a single platform.



TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY
THROUGH INNOVATION ➤

FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN ➤

BECOME A CLIENT ➤

CASE STUDY EXAMPLE:

Arm & Hammer Animal Nutrition Grows Y2Y Revenue 30%+

Let's jump back to the animal nutrition team at Arm & Hammer.

This business provides animal nutrition, animal productivity, food processing, and safety solutions. Just like other businesses in the industry, they had been relying on animal nutrition consultants to inform their product innovations.

But when they applied Jobs Theory, they realized they were looking at their market and customers all wrong.

First, their real customer was the dairy producer, not the nutritionist. By shifting the focus to this customer, Arm & Hammer was able to understand the "job" the dairy producer was trying to get done had little to do with nutrition — and was squarely focused on optimizing dairy herd productivity. The market they were in was dairy producers (a group of people) trying to optimize dairy herd productivity (job-to-be-done).

With this new insight, Arm & Hammer interviewed a dozen dairy producers and uncovered 165 unique desired outcome statements the dairy producer was trying to satisfy. The team then surveyed more dairy herd producers to quantify the degree to which each outcome was under- or overserved by existing products in the market. This was the data they needed to guide their decision making around their new products and take the guesswork out of their innovation process.

The team was surprised to see how many opportunities there were — and how few of them were directly related to nutritional ingredients. These insights told the team to build a new messaging strategy that focused on the specific outcomes that would deliver value to the dairy producers, rather than their traditional approach of focusing on nutritional features.

This change in messaging strategy alone led to year-over-year revenue growth of 30%+.

As Arm & Hammer VP Scott Druker explained,

"We started to see results from our new messaging and positioning strategy almost immediately. It contributed to an outstanding year. In the end, we grew greater than 30%.... Every one of our products had double-digit growth. We far outpaced our competitors."

Summary of Insights from Jobs-to-be-Done Theory

Knowing that customers buy products to get a core job done leads to a few insights:

- Your focus is not on reacting to customer feedback or product trends in the market. It is to create solutions that improve people's ability to get the core job done.
- Markets are not defined as categories of products/services (e.g., the animal nutrition market). They are defined as groups of people trying to get a job done (e.g., dairy producers optimizing herd productivity).
- Competitors are not only companies that make products like yours. They are any solution (paid and non-paid) that customers use to get the core job done.

When your company thinks about a market from this perspective, you are much more likely to create and deliver extraordinary products and services. Product managers can more successfully conceptualize new products, improve existing products, and prioritize backlog, for example. Marketing managers can use this approach to design web pages, campaigns, and sales pitches that convert, and create content that attracts leads. Executives have the insights they need to align the organization around a common vision, inform M&A activity, and discover new markets to enter.

All thanks to a new lens and a better understanding of the customer's needs.

WHAT'S NEXT?

LEARN WHO YOUR CUSTOMER IS THROUGH THE **Jobs-to-be-Done Framework.**

At this point, you're probably wondering how you can get started with applying these tenets to your own marketing and innovation practices.

In the next chapter of this playbook, you'll learn how to identify your real customer and frame their job-to-be-done — just like Arm & Hammer did.

We'll include more case examples, as well as downloadable tools to help you along in the process. ■



CHAPTER

02

Define Your Market

Companies often define the markets they serve around the technology in their product offerings— a technology that one day will become obsolete.



TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY
THROUGH INNOVATION ↗

FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN ↗

BECOME A CLIENT ↗

Clearly, this is a mistake, but it's one that has been repeated by hundreds of companies over the decades. And where are Blockbuster and Kodak now? Where are the companies that defined themselves around CDs? They spiraled to their death when MP3 technology came along.

Many companies today find themselves in this same situation.

A market, which is the focal point of everything a company does, should not be defined around something so unstable that it is only valid until the next product iteration. Instead, you should define your market around something that is stable for decades, making long-term strategic investments more attractive and providing the company with a vision for the future..

The customer's job-to-be-done provides that stable focal point around which you can create value—and define your market. More specifically, you should define your market as a group of people and the job they are trying to get done

A Market =

A Group
of People

+

The Job
They're Trying
to Get Done

Parents (*a group of people*) who are trying to **pass on life lessons to their children** (*the job-to-be-done*) constitute a market.

Dental hygienists who clean patients' teeth and farmers who grow a crop also constitute markets.

When defined in this way, there are tens of thousands of markets out there, and many of them have been around for decades—even centuries.

When it comes to getting a job done, people (job executors) don't want to cobble a solution together from multiple, incompatible offerings.

They want one solution that gets the whole job done. When you focus on the job-to-be-done, you are more likely to gradually evolve your products over time to get the entire job done and better satisfy your customers.

To help you define your market through this lens, we have created the **Jobs-to-be-Done Market Definition Canvas**.

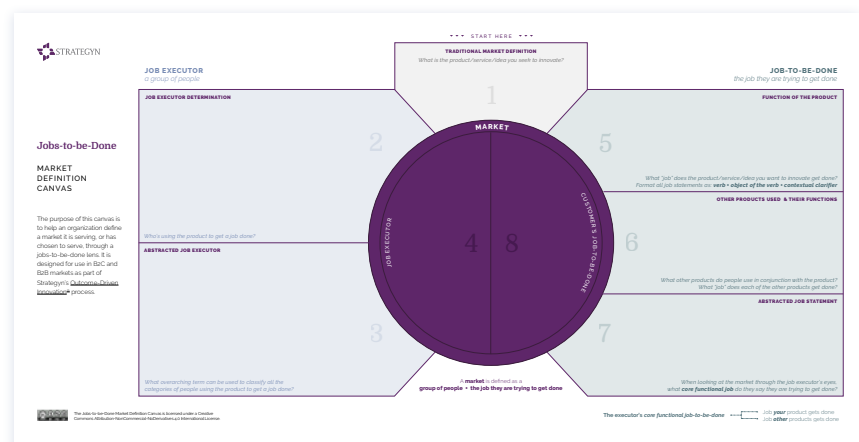
In this chapter, we'll explore how to use the Market Definition Canvas to define your job executor and the job they're trying to get done.

The Jobs-to-be-Done Market Definition Canvas

If you have a product in mind, you have already assumed a market but may not have formally defined it. The Jobs-to-be-Done Market Definition Canvas is designed to help you define the market you are in or have chosen to serve through a Jobs-to-be-Done lens.

The canvas lets you start by defining your market in solution space and guides you to redefine it in problem space as [a group of people] + [the job they are trying to get done].

The Market Definition Canvas is designed to accommodate both B2C and B2B applications. While it is optimized to define single-sided markets, you can complete it twice to define both sides of a double-sided market (e.g. component manufacturers who sell to OEMs or who are at the top of a long distribution chain).



Download your copy of the [Market Definition Canvas](#).

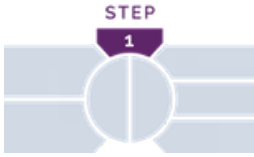
Let's explore, step by step, how the canvas can be used to define the market you have chosen to serve.



TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY
THROUGH INNOVATION

FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN

BECOME A CLIENT



01

Traditional market definition

What is the product/service/idea you seek to innovate?

The market definition exercise starts with something you're familiar with — a product focus. What is the product, service, or idea you're looking to innovate around? Use this as your grounding point.

The subsequent steps will help transition you from a product view to a Jobs-to-be-Done view of your market.



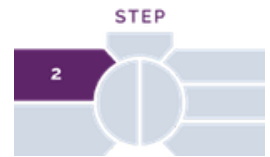
TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY
THROUGH INNOVATION

FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN

BECOME A CLIENT

02

Validate the job executor



Who's using the product to get a job done?

The transformation begins with this step.

Ask yourself (or your sales and marketing teams), who's using your product to get a job done? The goal of this step is to reveal the diverse set of potential product users. List all the categories of people who use or would use the product of interest to extract its value.

Keep in mind, we are focused here on stating the job executors. Do not list out influencers, economic buyers, people who support the product throughout its lifecycle, or other customer types, just job executors.



KEY CONCEPT

The **job executor** uses a product or service to get the core functional job done. They are the reason the market exists.

03

Abstracted job executor



What overarching term can be used to classify all the categories of people using the product to get a job done?

With a list of all the distinct categories of people using, or potentially using, your product, next, you want to define the one overarching term that can be used to classify or describe all these people as a single group.

Remember, we are defining a market as a group of people + the job-to-be-done. When defining the group of people, try not to use an actual job title. Instead, look for an all-inclusive term that encapsulates all job executors, usually a higher-level, generic term.

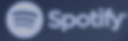


Imagine you are part of each of the businesses below.
Who uses your products or services?

BUSINESS

JOB EXECUTOR

MUSIC
STREAMING
SERVICE



MUSIC
ENTHUSIAST

TOOTHBRUSH
MANUFACTURER

CONSUMER

SURGICAL
DEVICE
MANUFACTURER

SURGEONS

The Bosch team, for example, abstracted roofers, framers, plumbers, finish carpenters, etc., into a higher-level category using the term “tradespeople.” In other words, the “group of people” using circular saws was conveniently referred to as tradespeople.

For those of you producing consumer product goods, the job executors are often referred to simply as “consumers.”

04

Job executor

STEP

4

The group of people (job executor) is defined as: _____

You may have come up with more than one way to describe your “group of people.” Now, it’s time to make and document your final choice. Choose a label that represents all types of people using the product, service, or idea you have in mind.

For example, you may choose the term surgeons over cardiac surgeons, or tradespeople over tradesmen to be more inclusive. Other examples include educators over teachers, accountants over tax preparers, or consumers over adults.

It is important to define the “group of people” before defining the job-to-be-done, as you will be interviewing representatives of the group to determine, from them alone, the way they define the job they are trying to get done.



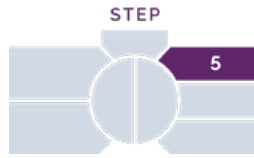
TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY
THROUGH INNOVATION ↗

FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN ↗

BECOME A CLIENT ↗

05

Function of the product



What “job” does your product/service help the job executor accomplish?

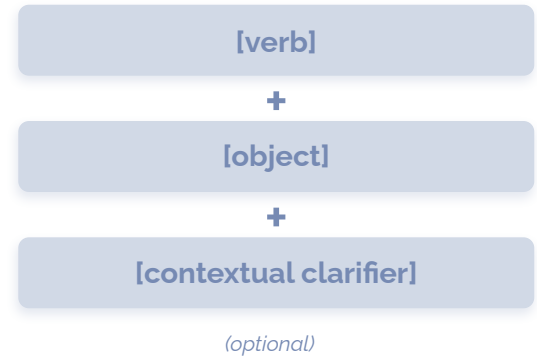
Products don't have jobs-to-be-done—people do. But to uncover the targeted group's job-to-be-done, it's helpful to start by understanding what function/job the product you have in mind performs.

To make this determination, you can work with your product team, or | preferably you can go directly to the group of people (defined in step 4) and ask the question:

What does the product or service we have in mind help you accomplish from a functional perspective?

Create a list of possible job statements according to the following **job statement formula**.

THE PRODUCT WILL HELP THE GROUP OF PEOPLE:



For example, a kettle may be used to:
[heat] + [water] + [to the desired temperature]

A dental drill may be used to:
[contour] + [the shape] + [of a tooth]

EXAMPLE JOB STATEMENTS:

VERB		OBJECT		CONTEXTUAL CLARIFIER
Listen	+	to music	+	on the go
Pass on	+	life lessons	+	to children
Maintain	+	oral hygiene	+	
Repair	+	a rotator cuff	+	



TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY
THROUGH INNOVATION

FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN

BECOME A CLIENT

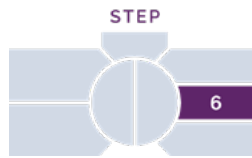
Keep in mind, the job your product gets done may or may not encompass the full job your customers are trying to get done. While people may use a kettle to heat water to the desired temperature, the overall job they are trying to get done may be to:

[prepare] + [a hot beverage] + [for consumption]

The goal of the market definition canvas is to help innovators uncover the job-to-be-done as perceived by the customer—not the product developer.

06

Traditional market definition



What other products do people use in conjunction with the product? What "job" does each of the other products get done?

To get a feel for the entire job your customer is trying to get done, ask them what other products they use immediately before, while, and immediately after using your product/service.

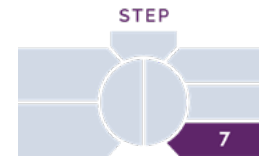
For example, when tradespeople use a circular saw to "cut wood," what other products are they using in conjunction with a circular saw? Perhaps they are also using a T-square, a measuring tape, sandpaper, and/or a pencil.

List the products they use in conjunction with the one you have in mind.

Next, document the functions / jobs that each of these other products gets done for the group of people. Use the same format used previously:

[verb] + [object of the verb] +
[contextual clarifier (optional)]

The Bosch team, for example, determined through customer interviews that, while the function of the circular saw was to "cut wood" (a job statement), tradespeople were using a T-square to "make a cut in a straight line" (a job statement), and that they were using a pencil to "mark the cut path" (a job statement).



07

Abstracted job statement

When looking at the market through the job executor's eyes, what core functional job do they say they are trying to get done?

Putting all the pieces together helps reveal the customer's ultimate job-to-be-done at the right level of abstraction. Assume your product is getting part of a job done. Assume people are using these other products to complete the entire job-to-be-done.

You want to define your customer's job-to-be-done in a way that includes your product's function (job) and rationalizes why customers are using all these other products as they cobble together a complete solution.



TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY
THROUGH INNOVATION ↗

FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN ↗

BECOME A CLIENT ↗



Using the same cases as above, what *Job* is the job executor ultimately trying to get done by using your products and services?



The Bosch team, for example, determined that tradespeople are using a circular saw along with other products so they can "cut wood in a straight line" (the abstracted job statement).

The reason for defining the market at this level of abstraction is so you can evolve your product over time to help customers get more, and eventually all, of their job done—preferably before competitors do.

Defining a market in this manner offers the innovator a built-in path and vision for growth — tied directly to what customers are trying to accomplish.

Make sure you encapsulate the job of the product you have in mind in the abstracted job statement. If the job of the product is not represented, you have abstracted the job statement to too high a level. This will ultimately prevent you from capturing customer need statements that will help inform the improvement of the product you have in mind.



TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY
THROUGH INNOVATION

FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN

BECOME A CLIENT



THE IMPORTANCE OF CUSTOMER INTERVIEWS

Relying on your market views to define the job-to-be-done may lead you astray.

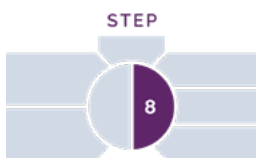
One team, for example, who thought its tax products were being used for the job of “prepare taxes” was surprised to learn the real job was to “formulate and execute a tax strategy.”



If you'd like to learn more about the customer interview process, check out our [***ODIpro online course offerings.***](#) ↗

08

Customer's Job-to-be-Done



Now that you have your customer's job abstracted appropriately, you can document that job in this box. If you have multiple versions of the job statement, work with job executors to gain consensus on the best version.

TIPS FOR

Defining Your Job-to-be-Done

- 1. Don't overcomplicate it.** A functional job statement should not be multilayered and complex. It should be one-dimensional and simple.
- 2. Your internal team must agree that the job is defined at the right level of abstraction.** You don't want to study a job that's outside your company's core or desired capabilities.
- 3. The core job should consider all the products that people cobble together in a specific situation.** The job should be defined around what people are trying to accomplish, not what a specific product does.

Market—defined.

When you've completed the Market Definition Canvas, you have your market defined through a jobs-to-be-done lens:

Your market =
Group of people (Step 4) + Job-to-be-Done (Step 8)



TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY
THROUGH INNOVATION ↗

FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN ↗

BECOME A CLIENT ↗

With your market clearly defined around a stable point of value creation, you are in a strong position to iterate quickly and more reliably succeed in your market.

Summary of Insights from Jobs-to-be-Done Theory

- **The first step in using jobs-to-be-done to guide your strategy is defining the job executor**—this is the person that uses your product or service to get a job done.
- **The second step is to frame the job executor's job-to-be-done.**
While products come and go, the job is stable over time. Ask your customers and subject matter experts what they're trying to accomplish. Reach consensus with your customers on the best stated version of the job-to-be-done.
- **It's important to get the level abstraction correct on the job-to-be-done.** Define your job too narrowly and you'll limit your growth opportunities. Define it too broadly and you won't be able to deliver a better solution.

WHAT'S NEXT?

CREATE A JOB MAP TO GUIDE THE Discovery of Market Opportunities

Great work!

You just defined your job executor and their core functional job-to-be-done.

You and your team now have a shared focal point for value creation. This marks a major milestone in your innovation journey! Knowing the target is the first step in creating solutions that hit the target.

In Chapter 3, we'll cover everything you need to know to build a job map. ■



CHAPTER

03

Build Your Job Map

Microsoft was facing a full-on potential crisis. They had evidence that their Software Assurance offering was not providing the right mix of benefits to their customers. Traditionally, they had viewed this offering mostly as a vehicle to aid in the purchase of software upgrades.



TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY
THROUGH INNOVATION ↗

FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN ↗

BECOME A CLIENT ↗

But IT budgets were facing increased scrutiny. Their renewals were declining. And Microsoft saw a lot of potential revenue at risk.

As one tech reporter observed, *"There appears to be some disconnect between how Microsoft wants to sell its software and how businesses want to buy."*

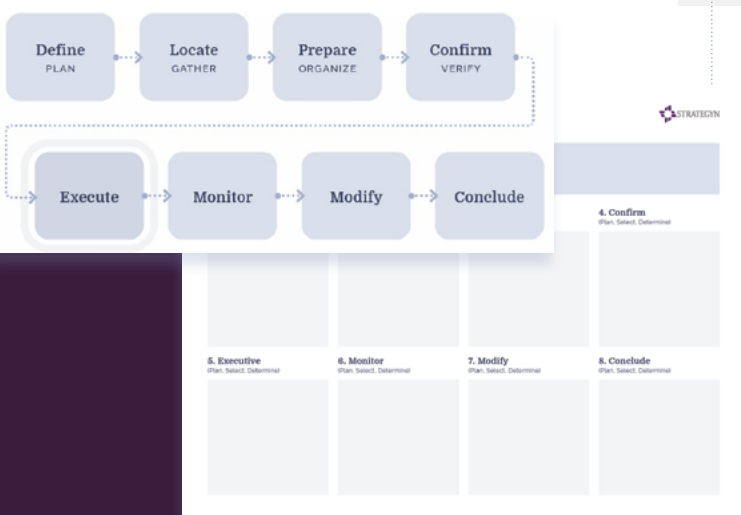
They were under increasing pressure to give customers more reasons to renew. Fast.

So they created a job map.

The job map is a visual depiction of the job your customers are trying to get done that allows you to deconstruct each and every step of the process. It clarifies and visualizes what your customers are trying to get done as specific process steps, capturing all of their needs along the way.

"...we realized that we were only really engaging with the customer in one tiny piece of their job—the purchase of the software. But this was just part of a much bigger challenge that they faced. We were not engaging with them in many of these other areas that were very important to them and where they were very dissatisfied."

Creating a job map is revelatory for many brands.



Download the job map template, [↗](#)
and begin building your job map today.



TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY
THROUGH INNOVATION [↗](#)

FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN [↗](#)

BECOME A CLIENT [↗](#)

It's the job map that turns the fundamentals of Jobs Theory into a reliable, repeatable innovation practice. Companies often realize they're addressing less of the customer's job than they could be, which allows them to systematically identify opportunities for growth.

! KEY CONCEPT

The job executor uses a product or service to get the core functional job done. **They are the reason the market exists.**

Creating a **job map** helps you to:

- **DEFINE VISION AND DIRECTION.**

The completed job map lays out a long-term strategy and vision for your organization— which is to devise a solution that gets the entire job done on a single platform or with a single offering.

- **DISCOVER OPPORTUNITIES.**

It is often the case that competitive insights and innovative ideas can come from analyzing the job map, as it points out holes and deficiencies in existing solutions.

- **GUIDE CUSTOMER NEEDS GATHERING.**

From a tactical standpoint, the job map serves as a framework and a guide for capturing the customer's desired outcomes.

This chapter of our Jobs-to-be-Done Playbook outlines what goes into a job map—and what doesn't. We'll also cover how to get started building your own, so you can figure out exactly what value to add to your own products or services.

Just like what
Microsoft did to
double their year-
over-year Software
Assurance revenue.

What a job map is **NOT**

It's **not** a process map.

It's **not** a customer journey or customer experience map.

It does **not** describe the journey the customer goes through to buy, receive, set-up, use, up-grade, clean or maintain a product.

If you are focusing on the purchase process or the customer experience, you are not focused on documenting the customer's core functional job.

A job map also does not show what the customer is doing (a solution view).

For example, when an anesthesiologist checks a monitor during a surgical procedure, it's not just for fun. The point is NOT just to look at the monitor. It's a means to an end.

Instead, a good job map describes what the customer is trying to get done (a needs view) —independent of the solution they are using.

For the anesthesiologist, the job may be detecting a change in patient vital signs. Whether your customers are in the USA, India or South Africa, or whether they are using any number of competing products, a single job map will describe what each and every customer is trying to accomplish. The anesthesiologist's job doesn't change just because she's in another part of the world using a different kind of monitor.

The components of a job map

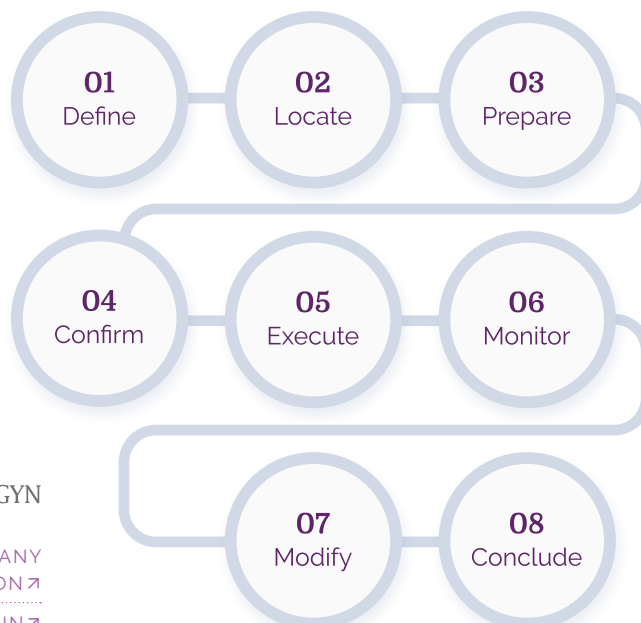
Your completed job map represents your customer's ideal process flow for their job. It depicts all the steps to complete the job in the ideal order for efficient execution.

We've analyzed hundreds—if not, thousands—of customer jobs over the years. We've mapped jobs for products and for services. We've mapped jobs for durable and consumable goods, chemicals, software, professional and consumer services, and many other industries.

► Our work has shown us the jobs map has the following 8 steps.

NOTE:

Not all job maps will have every step.



Your goal is to uncover what your customers are trying to do during each of these steps—then look for opportunities to help get each step done better (faster, more cheaply, and/or with more output/throughput).

Let's take a deeper look at each process step and how to uncover key insights for each.



TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY
THROUGH INNOVATION ↗

FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN ↗

BECOME A CLIENT ↗



INTERVIEWING TIP

At each job step **ask these questions** when interviewing your customers.

- When starting the job, what is the first thing you are trying to accomplish?

- After completing [previous step], what is it that you are trying to accomplish next?

- Once complete: is there any step missing before, during or after the steps shown?

STEP

01 Define

Many jobs include an element of planning. **This is the step in which your customers:**

- Determine their objectives
- Plan their approach to completing the job



HOW TO INNOVATE AT THIS STEP IN THE JOB MAP

You should be looking for ways to help your customers understand their objectives, simplify the resource-planning process, and reduce the amount of planning needed.

Let's take a look at the job of losing weight. Few people go into this job without a bit of planning —how much weight they want to lose, what sorts of foods they'll eat and which they'll avoid, how to incorporate exercise, etc.

Weight Watchers offers a solid example of helping customers to get this step of their job done better. By offering a system that doesn't require calorie counting, the brand helps to streamline the diet planning process. The brand also offers a variety of recipes that fit easily into their points-based program. People looking to lose weight can worry less about what they're eating by following the Weight Watchers program.



TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY
THROUGH INNOVATION ↗

FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN ↗

BECOME A CLIENT ↗



BACK TO JOB MAP

STEP 02 Locate

Many jobs include an element of planning. Your customer often needs certain inputs to get a job done—these inputs can be tangible or intangible steps in which your customers:

TANGIBLE INPUTS

- The surgical tools a nurse must locate for an operation.
- The cookware and ingredients a chef needs to prepare a meal.

INTANGIBLE INPUTS

- Business or other requirements that a software developer uses when writing code.
- The audience personas a marketer needs to design a campaign.

! HOW TO INNOVATE AT THIS STEP IN THE JOB MAP

The goal of understanding this step of the job map is to find opportunities to streamline the gathering process. For example, your solution might make it easier to bring required components together—or eliminate the need for some components altogether.

Consider meal kit solutions like Hello Fresh and Blue Apron. These kits provide nearly all of the ingredients you need to streamline the process of preparing a meal. Instead of spending time going to the store and shopping for all of your ingredients, they come pre-packaged and pre-portioned—and they're delivered right to your door. The kits also list out each of the tools you'll need to prepare the meal, which makes the "location" step much easier for the cook..

Abbott Medical Optics (AMO) is a leading provider of lenses, insertion systems, laser vision correction systems, and other devices for cataract and refractive surgical procedures. When AMO examined this step of the job map, they realized it was a big problem for their customers if they did not have the right lenses on hand for a cataract surgical case. Their solution was to make it easier to get the lenses when customers needed them by creating an advanced schedule-planning and inventory management software module that facilitates accurate and timely replenishment.

[Check out the full AMO case study ↗](#)



TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY
THROUGH INNOVATION ↗

FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN ↗

BECOME A CLIENT ↗

STEP 03 Prepare

Once your customer has inputs for a job in hand, they often have to set up and organize these inputs. It may also be necessary to prepare a working surface or some other aspect of the physical environment.

- The financial planner must organize all financial accounts and records before creating a new investment plan.
- The painter removes furniture, cleans the wall, and sets up drop cloths before applying the first coat of paint.



HOW TO INNOVATE AT THIS STEP IN THE JOB MAP

At this stage, you want to look at ways to make setup less difficult for your

- Make it easier to organize physical materials
- Make it easier to organize and analyze required data
- Create guides and safeguards to ensure the proper arrangement of the work area

Bosch learned of one opportunity to help customers prepare to cut wood when professional roofers told the company that they would like a way to speed the process of setting bevel levels on their saws. Accordingly, Bosch added adjustable levers to its CS20 circular saw to accommodate the most common bevel adjustments such as 30°, 45°, and 60°. This reduced the time needed to cut the wood and increased the accuracy of the adjustments.

[Check out the full Bosch case study ↗](#)



STRATEGY

TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY
THROUGH INNOVATION ↗

FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN ↗

BECOME A CLIENT ↗



BACK TO JOB MAP

STEP

04 Confirm

Many jobs include an element of planning.

THIS INCLUDES CONFIRMING THINGS LIKE:

- Priorities and plans are aligned regarding execution options
- Tangible and intangible inputs are of acceptable quality and functional capacity
- Materials and the working environment have been properly prepared



HOW TO INNOVATE AT THIS STEP IN THE JOB MAP

There are a couple of ways you can differentiate your solution at this step of the job map:

- Help customers gain access to the types of information and feedback they need to confirm readiness and decide among execution alternatives.
- Search for ways to build confirmation into the locating and preparing steps (which would help the customer to proceed through the job more quickly and easily).

For example, **Oracle's ProfitLogic** merchandising optimization software removes the responsibility from the merchandiser for confirming the optimal timing and level of markdowns by analyzing thousands of different demand scenarios at the individual product level and recommending the scenario for each product that is likely to yield the highest profit.

STEP

05 Execute

It's time to actually DO the job—and your customer wants to get it *right*. Whether they're feeding cattle or surgically removing cataracts, customers consider the execution step the most important part of the job. It's also the most visible step (and no one wants to make mistakes in the limelight).

With all of this in mind, customers are especially concerned about avoiding problems and delays at this stage of the game—as well as achieving optimal results.



HOW TO INNOVATE AT THIS STEP IN THE JOB MAP

Your best opportunity to add value at this step is to provide customers with real-time feedback or to automatically correct execution problems. You can also come up with ways to keep performance consistent in different contexts.

Kimberly-Clark's Patient Warming System

is a good example of value added in this way. The system relies on a control unit that automatically circulates heated water through thermal pads placed on the patient to avoid temperature spikes during surgery. The system can maintain normal patient temperature with only 20% of the patient body covered, which means the device performs consistently and efficiently in a variety of complex surgical procedures.



TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY
THROUGH INNOVATION ↗

FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN ↗

BECOME A CLIENT ↗



BACK TO JOB MAP

STEP 06 Monitor

Once the execution step is underway, many jobs also require some sort of monitoring to make sure things are going well. In this case, customers need to keep an eye on results during execution. This helps them determine whether things are on track—or whether they have to make some adjustments. A digital marketer needs to monitor campaign performance to ensure return on ad spend, for example.

For some jobs, customers must also monitor environmental factors to see if and when they might need to make some changes.

Some of this monitoring is passive and doesn't require the customer to put in much effort (like the way a pacemaker monitors heartbeats).

! HOW TO INNOVATE AT THIS STEP IN THE JOB MAP

The goal of understanding this step of the job map is to find opportunities to streamline the gathering process. For example, your solution might make it easier to bring required components together—or eliminate the need for some components altogether.

You can also offer new value by linking your monitoring innovations with improved job execution or by providing diagnostic feedback.

Consider how fitness tools and apps like the **Apple Watch, Fitbit and MyFitnessPal** help users monitor their physical activity and diet. They offer real-time monitoring on heart rate, steps per minute, calorie burn, calorie intake, run distance and pace, etc. to help users improve results of their diet and exercise efforts. Customers can set reminders to move their bodies at certain intervals, and these tools even integrate with scales to monitor weight.



TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY
THROUGH INNOVATION ↗

FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN ↗

BECOME A CLIENT ↗

STEP 07 Modify

Executing the job doesn't always go perfectly. If monitoring indicates something needs to change, your customer needs to look at performing updates, adjustments or maintenance.

The digital marketer monitoring an ad campaign might notice it's not producing the intended results—and therefore need to make adjustments to the messaging, creative, or target audience, for example.



HOW TO INNOVATE AT THIS STEP IN THE JOB MAP

Searching for the right adjustment can be time-consuming and expensive.

Your innovation should consider ways to help customers get execution back on track when there are problems—and preventing problems in the first place.

At the modification step, you can innovate by helping customers:

- Decide what should be adjusted
- Determine when, how, and where to make changes
- Reduce the time needed to make adjustments

Many software programs perform well at supporting this step. Microsoft, for example, assists customers with the job of modifying their computer to protect against security threats. Automatic updates of its operating system remove the hassle of determining which updates are necessary, finding them, and ensuring that fixes are compatible with various elements of the operating system.



STRATEGY

TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY
THROUGH INNOVATION ↗

FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN ↗

BECOME A CLIENT ↗



BACK TO JOB MAP

STEP

08 Conclude

It's obvious when you finish up a simple job brushing your teeth. But more complex jobs often have some steps related to wrapping things up. The painter needs to remove painter's tape, clean up and store/dispose of unused supplies, and return the furniture to its proper positions.

Customers often think of concluding steps as a bit of a pain—because the core job has already been completed.



HOW TO INNOVATE AT THIS STEP IN THE JOB MAP

There are a couple of ways to help customers better finish their jobs.

- Simplify the conclusion process (to make it less painful)
- Design desired benefits into an earlier step in the process
- Make sure these concluding activities are closely connected to the starting point of a new job cycle (in the case of a cyclical job)

3M's Coban Self-Adherent Wrap. for example, offers a convenient way for medical personnel to secure wound dressings at the end of treatment, because it is made of a material that stretches and adheres only to itself. This self-adherence property makes the wrap easy to remove, because it doesn't stick to patient skin or the wound. 3M designed the product in such a way that putting on the wrap anticipates the act of taking it off.

A look at the full job map ▶

To further illustrate, let's follow a customer's steps through the job map for a single job: **painting a room.**



TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY
THROUGH INNOVATION

FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN

BECOME A CLIENT



BACK TO JOB MAP



HOW TO INNOVATE AT THIS STEP IN THE JOB MAP

1.

You may be tempted to write the process for how a job executor gets the job done. Anytime you think about "how," immediately consider "why" instead.

2.

A typical job map will include between 10 to 20 steps (there are usually multiple planning, gathering, and executing steps, for example).

3.

List the steps in the order that would be the most ideal for efficient execution (not necessarily the same as the order the customer is completing them now).

4.

Write steps in proper format:

[verb] + [object] +
[contextual clarifier].

5.

Do not include any reference to a particular solution in your job map.

Interviewing customers to build your job map

Now you understand what a job map is, how to build one, and how to use it.

But the best job maps include customer insights gleaned from interviews.. Once you've defined your *job-to-be-done* ↗, interviewing these job executors helps to validate your other internal and external research and refine your job map.



To learn how to incorporate these additional customers into the innovation process, check out our [ODIpro online course offerings](#). ↗



[Download the job map template](#), ↗ and begin building your job map today.



TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY
THROUGH INNOVATION ↗

FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN ↗

BECOME A CLIENT ↗

Summary of Insights from Jobs-to-be-Done

- **A job map is not a process map, a customer journey, or customer experience map.** It does not describe the journey the customer goes through to buy, receive, set-up, use, upgrade, clean or maintain a product. A job map also does not show what the customer is doing (a solution view). If you are focusing on the purchase process or the customer experience, you are not focused on documenting the customer's core functional job.
- **A good job map describes what the customer is trying to get done (a needs view) —independent of the solution they are using.** Your completed job map represents your customer's ideal process flow for their job. It depicts all the steps to complete the job in the ideal order for efficient execution.

- **Job maps are composed of a combination of eight steps: define, locate, prepare, confirm, execute, monitor, modify, conclude.** Your goal is to uncover what your customers are trying to do during each of these steps—then look for opportunities to help get each step done better (faster, more cheaply, and/or with more output/throughput).

WHAT'S NEXT?

Put Jobs-to-be-Done into practice

Great work!

You just built your customer's job map.

You and your team now have the ability to map out each step of your customer's job-to-be-done so you can add more value every step of the way. Congratulations on another milestone in your innovation journey!

In Chapter 4, we will be showing you how the job map aligns the entire organization around a common understanding of the customer, and all the ways the job map will help you in your role. ■



CHAPTER

04

Product, Marketing, and Executive teams put JTBD into practice

Years ago, teams at medical device company Cordis Corporation were battling over how to best serve their customers. Team members from sales, marketing, development, and R&D all had different ideas, and each was convinced they knew the best way forward.



TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY
THROUGH INNOVATION ↗

FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN ↗

BECOME A CLIENT ↗

Each function argued its points vehemently until team members were quite literally red in the face. Some resorted to personal attacks. It was ugly.

While each team member and each function was motivated to create customer value, the groups could not align around the best way to make it happen. **Unfortunately, misalignment between teams is common.**

Fortunately, putting Jobs-to-be-Done into practice helps you to solve for it.

Once Cordis had a clear understanding of their customer's job and job map, they were able to quickly align their teams and begin brainstorming solutions. **In a matter of about 90 minutes, the team went from red-faced fighting to realistic product solutions to help the customer get their job done better.**

Cordis' revenues nearly doubled within two years of launching these solutions.

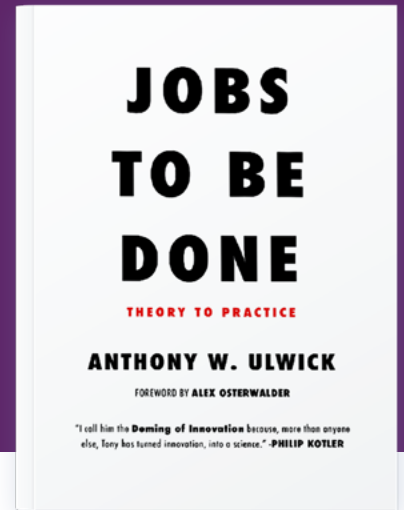
Cordis then went on to develop the stent, which became the fastest-growing product in medical device history, producing nearly **\$1 billion in revenue in its first year.**

With Jobs-to-be-Done, all functions in the business can align around a common understanding of the customer and how to add value for that customer. You can get everyone rowing in the same direction, so to speak—stripping out the biases like technology preference, opinion, or politics—to **get down to what matters to the customer.**



Take your Jobs-to-be-Done practice to the next level.

Download your free copy of [*Tony Ulwick's book Jobs-to-be-Done: Theory to Practice.*](#) ↗



Let's take a deeper dive into what this looks like across product, marketing and executive teams.

Product Teams

Product teams can launch the next big thing with new insights like:

- Do our products get the **entire job done**, or only parts of the job?
- What **holes** exist in our portfolio?
- Are customers **cobbling together solutions** to get the entire job done?
- What product in our portfolio **holds the potential** to get the entire job done?

Marketing Teams

Marketing can position and communicate most effectively with answers to questions such as:

- How can we **better market/position** our current offerings?
- How should we **modify our marketing** communications?
- How should we **adjust our content**?

Executives

Executives can confidently grow the business with answers to questions like:

- How can we **align our teams** around value creation?
- Are we really delivering on **customer-centricity**?
- What should we **innovate** to become a preferred solution in the market?
- What **non-traditional** competitors should be on our radar?



TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY
THROUGH INNOVATION ↗

FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN ↗

BECOME A CLIENT ↗

Product Teams

How **product teams** launch the next big thing

Marketing, sales, executives, R&D, even your customers—everyone has their ideas for potential products and features. And they all go to bat for them. Then decisions are often made based on who speaks the loudest or has the most clout instead of what will actually benefit the customer.

But using Jobs-to-be-Done and the customer's job map offers a more efficient and reliable way to define and execute against your product roadmap—and nail your next product launch.

Your sole focus becomes figuring out how to help the customer get their job done better and/or more cheaply.



Using the approach we've outlined in this playbook, you get concrete answers to questions like:

- Do our products get the **entire job done** —or only parts of the job?
- What **holes** exist in our portfolio?
- Are customers **cobbling together solutions** to get the entire job done?
- What product in our portfolio **holds the potential** to get the entire job done?

With this knowledge, you know exactly where to add value in your solutions to solve for real customer needs—and **can align your teams around these efforts.**



TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY
THROUGH INNOVATION ↗

FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN ↗

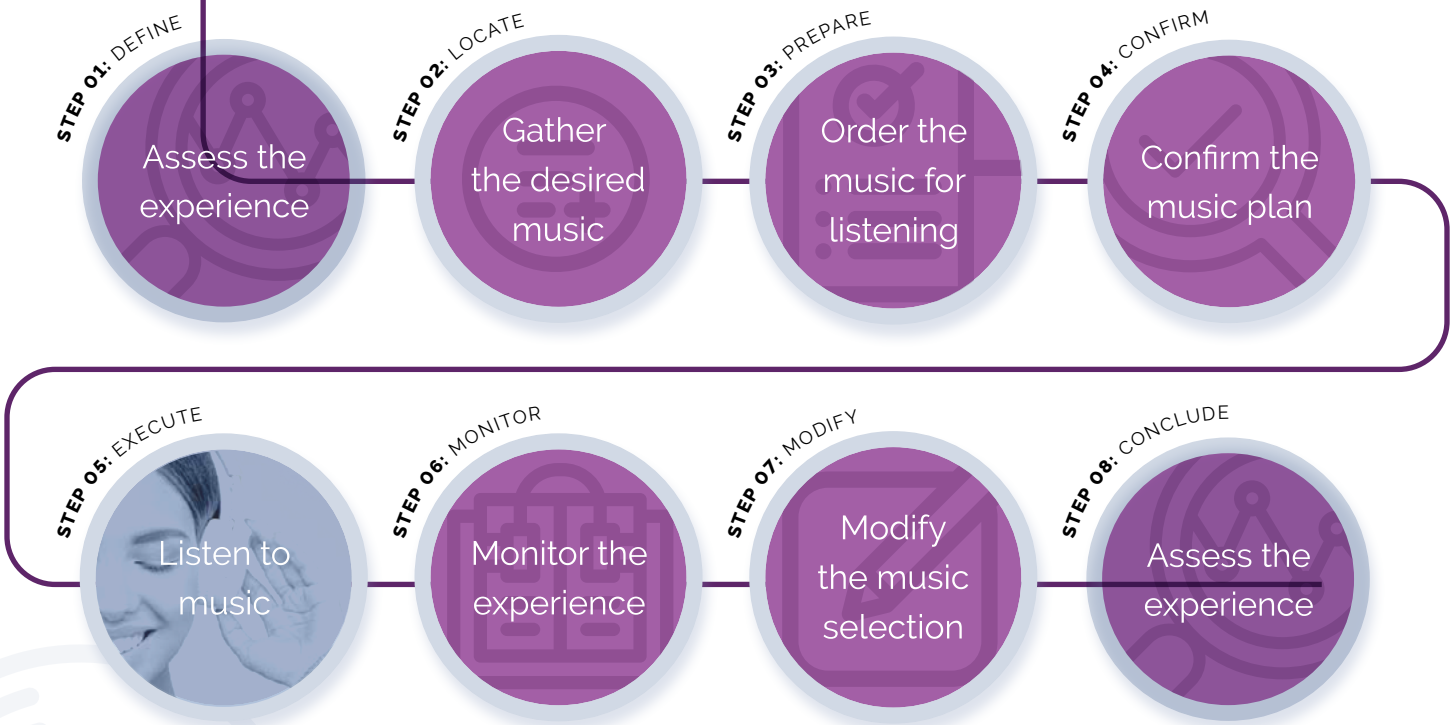
BECOME A CLIENT ↗

LET'S TAKE A LOOK AT AN EXAMPLE OF HOW THIS WORKS ▼

EXAMPLE

From LPs to streaming—music technologies evolve around the job-to-be-done

Consider the job map for the job of “**listening to music.**”



Not too long ago, the market solution for listening to music was **the CD.**

While an improvement over the LP, the CD only helped the customer complete the “execute” step of the job map—and part of the “modify” step (by allowing the user to skip songs).

Despite the format wars of the 1990’s, where many companies invested millions of dollars in new technologies like the Digital Compact Cassette (DCC) and Sony’s MiniDisc, the CD was the preferred solution for the job of listening to music.

CD
JOB MAP
COMPLETED
STEPS



TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY
THROUGH INNOVATION ↗

FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN ↗

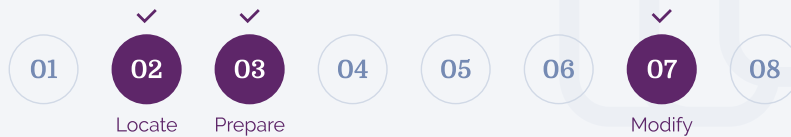
BECOME A CLIENT ↗

That was until a solution came along that gave consumers a solution that did more of the job.

While the manufacturers of CD's and the rest of the format wars were focused on one job step ("execute"), a new solution emerged that helped customers to complete more of the job. Creators said they would sacrifice sound quality to allow customers more control through the entire process of listening to music.

The Mp3 player turned the music industry upside down with the revolutionary ability to locate, organize, change, and listen to the music you wanted to listen to—without having to carry around a binder of CD's. Customers eagerly left CD-quality sound behind to get more of the job done.

MP3 PLAYER
JOB MAP
COMPLETED
STEPS



Fast forward to the present day where **streaming services** dominate the listening-to-music market.

The same way Mp3 players came along by doing more of the job, streaming services developed tools to prepare music for you, recommend new music, and share music automatically. Some devices even sense you are likely to be exercising (assessing the situation in the "define" step of the job map) and automatically play your favorite workout playlist.

STREAMING SERVICES
JOB MAP
COMPLETED
STEPS



TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY
THROUGH INNOVATION ↗

FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN ↗

BECOME A CLIENT ↗

As this example illustrates, the job map remains stable over time, while new technologies and solutions emerge that get more of the job done.

It's these more complete solutions that ultimately win in the marketplace.

A real-world product management success story

CASE STUDY

In late 2001, **Kroll Ontrack** was faced with a strategic opportunity—and a challenge.

The opportunity lay in the potential market for an electronic document discovery solution for the legal industry (until then, everything had been done on paper).

The challenge? Creating an effective market strategy for a business still in its infancy. They had failed on their first two attempts at market entry.

As **Ben Allen**, CEO of Kroll and former Kroll Ontrack president, explained:

"All of the underlying foundational elements suggested that this would be an important industry opportunity. What we didn't know was how to understand what clients wanted to achieve in a way that could be translated into an efficient and effective strategy for growth. The electronic discovery market was so new that if you asked clients what features they wanted, they didn't know what you were talking about."

Ben's team found the answers in the job map.

First, they defined their market around the job-to-be-done and the people executing that job. For Kroll, they focused on lawyers who were trying to find information (evidence) that would support or refute a case.

Then they created a job map describing the perfect execution of this job-to-be-done.

With this approach, Kroll discovered 9 opportunities to help their customer better complete job steps related to information management during the litigation process. They also found 11 opportunities related to extant electronic discovery approaches.

They built their product strategy and product roadmap accordingly—which worked out pretty well for them.

Andrea Johnson, VP of Marketing & Communications, explained:

"Kroll Ontrack leapfrogged the competition with a revolutionary innovation, because it added capabilities based on the job that customers were trying to get done rather than seeking to improve the current solution platform."

Innovate with confidence



TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY
THROUGH INNOVATION ↗

FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN ↗

BECOME A CLIENT ↗

Like Kroll, once you have determined where the opportunities exist, you can begin solutioning with confidence. It's easy to see which products and features to prioritize when you know exactly what your customers are trying to get done.

Marketing Teams

How **marketing teams** align around enviable messaging

Every day, consumers are bombarded with information, receiving up to 10,000 ads per day.

Because they are being bombarded, they only listen to people (and brands) that communicate simply, clearly, and to the problems they are looking to solve (the jobs they're trying to get done).

Confusing messages lead to all kinds of problems:

- Customers don't understand exactly what's offered.
- Salespeople can't differentiate products in the marketplace.
- Work is muddled and isn't connected to a deeper sense of meaning.
- The message is spoken in a thousand different ways.
- Word isn't spreading about the company's offering.
- Customers are going to competitors.

Jobs-to-be-Done [↗](#) helps marketers understand precisely what their customers want to align the entire organization around a clear and consistent messaging strategy that speaks to the problem.



Using the Jobs-to-be-Done Lens, you can answer key questions like:

- How can we **better market/position** our current offerings?
- How should we **modify** our marketing communications?
- How should we **adjust** our content?



TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY
THROUGH INNOVATION [↗](#)

FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN [↗](#)

BECOME A CLIENT [↗](#)

Why Marketing 101 is difficult to execute

Understanding your customers' unmet needs has always been Marketing 101. Why, then, is this still so difficult to execute?

There are two primary reasons.

1. Confusion around **who the primary customer is**
2. Confusion around **what a customer need is**

As we covered in Chapter 2: Define

Your Market , the primary customer

should always be the job executor.

This is the person that uses your product or service to get the core functional job done. They are the reason your market exists, control through the entire process of listening to music.

But there are other types of customers that can muddy the waters for marketers, including:

- **THE PURCHASE DECISION MAKER:**

The individual or group responsible for the purchase decision

- **THE PRODUCT LIFECYCLE SUPPORT TEAM:**

The individual or group who helps the job executor install, set up, store, transport, maintain, repair, clean, upgrade, and/or dispose of the product

The job executor is your most important customer—you don't want to confuse your job executor with other audiences. But it's important to consider the purchase decision maker and the product lifecycle support team in your messaging strategy, too.

The second challenge is that most companies do not agree on what a customer need is, let alone what their customers' needs are. In fact, we've found that 85% of teams do not have a common language for talking about customer needs. You may think in terms of excitors and delighters, while your colleague or boss messages to pain points and challenges. Just like product owners have lots of ideas as to how to best add customer value, so do marketers—and they're not all created equal.

This is the root cause of misalignment when it comes to creating and communicating value for customers. It's the common understanding of customer needs that allows you to create a clear and consistent messaging strategy.



TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY
THROUGH INNOVATION 

FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN 

BECOME A CLIENT 

Create enviable messaging with Jobs-to-be-Done

Considering these challenges, it should be no surprise that Jobs-to-be-Done opens the door for more effective marketing by clarifying who the customer is and what the customer's needs are at each step of the job map. ***(review Chapter 3: Build Your Job Map ↗).***

1. FOCUSING ON THE EXACT BENEFITS AND VALUE THAT MATTERS TO YOUR CUSTOMERS.

When you know exactly what your customer wants, you can align your organization around and deliver the most effective messaging—no flowery language or puns necessary.

2. UNCOVERING UNMET NEEDS THAT YOUR COMPETITION HAS FAILED TO ADDRESS.

This offers you the opportunity to reposition your offering in a new and differentiated way—maybe even redefine the category.

3. DISCOVERING NEW WAYS TO COMBINE SINGLE PRODUCTS OR POINT SOLUTIONS IN YOUR MESSAGING.

Your job map may show you have multiple products in your portfolio that can be pulled together to get the bigger job done. Rather than marketing them individually, you can bundle them together to help customers get more of their job done with a single solution.

4. IDENTIFYING EARLY ADOPTERS.

When you can identify segments of people that are struggling most to get the job done, you can find the people most likely to try your solution.



TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY
THROUGH INNOVATION ↗

FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN ↗

BECOME A CLIENT ↗

Real-world marketing success stories

You may remember our [Microsoft story from Chapter 3](#) —this software giant was able to double year-over-year revenue on their flailing Software Assurance offering, mostly by combining existing solutions to help customers get more of their job done and communicating that value appropriately.

And don't forget the success story from [Arm & Hammer's Animal Nutrition division in this playbook's introduction](#). After a series of lackluster product launches, the brand realized they were targeting the wrong customer with the wrong messaging. As it turns out, the job dairy farmers were trying to get done had little to do with nutrition— and everything to do with increasing herd productivity.

Arm & Hammer adjusted their messaging accordingly, which resulted in a **30% increase in revenue in the first year alone**.

*"We started to see results from our new messaging and positioning strategy almost immediately. It contributed to an outstanding year. In the end, **we grew greater than 30%**. Every one of our products had double-digit growth. We far outpaced our competitors."*

– SCOTT DRUKER VP, ARM & HAMMER

Coloplast also offers a stellar example of how Jobs-to-be-Done can provide vital messaging insights. As a leader in wound care products, the brand had always assumed that their primary value prop was helping wounds to heal faster. But it turns out that most of their customers were more concerned with preventing complications with the wound.

Just by switching up their messaging, Coloplast went from stagnant to double-digit growth in only six months.



Communicate with confidence

Like **Microsoft, Arm & Hammer and Coloplast**, you can also use Jobs-to-be-Done to identify and execute the most effective messaging strategy for your brand —which can be one of the fastest and simplest ways to growing revenue.



TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY
THROUGH INNOVATION ↗

FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN ↗

BECOME A CLIENT ↗

It's time to kill the status quo

Most people just accept that innovation is inherently unpredictable. But they're wrong. *And there's a better way.* Don't risk your product's potential with an outdated innovation methodology.



Contact us ↗ to learn about our innovation management consulting services.



Executives

How **executives** find a stable focal point for value creation

Product and marketing functions have specific roles to play in creating and communicating solutions to the market. Executives have the broader—and often more challenging—responsibility of keeping the entire business focused on achieving growth objectives..



TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY
THROUGH INNOVATION ↗

FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN ↗

BECOME A CLIENT ↗

Thankfully, looking at your business through the lens of **Jobs-to-be-Done** offers can help you solve for many of your most pressing challenges, such as:

- **Breaking down functional** silos to align your teams
- Delivering on **customer-centricity**
- Defining a **stable focal point** for value creation
- Becoming the **preferred solution** in your market
- **Staying ahead** of traditional and non-traditional competitors

Let's dive into how.

1. Break down functional silos to align your teams.

Companies are organized into functions, each optimized to serve a particular purpose. Sales, marketing, product development, R&D—they all have different goals, rely on different inputs to achieve those goals, and each has its own language for communicating how to create customer value.

For example:

- Sales is often focused on uncovering the customer's latent and unarticulated needs and presenting an appropriate solution.
- Marketing is focused on communicating the excitors and delighters; the benefits and the customer wants—all with the goal of demand generation.
- Product development communicates customer value in terms of product requirements and specifications. Their goal is to create winning products and services.
- R&D is all about implementing new technologies that anticipate future customer needs.

Because each function has its own way of defining what value means for the customer, companies struggle to align around customer problems and solutions to these problems.

But when you view your business through the lens of **Jobs-to-be-Done**, you can align your organization around its purpose, which is to help people get a job done.

Breaking down the job map aligns the organization around the steps the customer goes through to get that job done. This allows your siloed teams to all view value creation—and communication—through the eyes of the customer.

Coloplast offers a prime example.

Their team was struggling to gain traction in the market, thanks to a lack of agreement between sales, marketing, and product development as to what they should create and communicate next in their line of wound care products.

We already mentioned how understanding their customer's job helped Coloplast's marketers make impactful changes to their value proposition and messaging.

This simple alignment changed the trajectory of the firm for the long-term.

But understanding their customer's job and job map also helped the sales team to create new sales materials that pointed out exactly how their solutions addressed customer needs. The product development team knew exactly what products and features to create next in order to reinforce that new value proposition.

2. Deliver on customer-centricity.

Most executives would claim that their businesses are customer-centric—but how many of them actually are?

Most teams rely on an internally-focused approach to innovation and growth. Teams ideate around new technologies and solutions, creating prototypes, and testing them out to see how customers respond.

This is not customer-centricity. **It's solution-centricity.**

Using Jobs-to-be-Done is a paradigm shift, helping the business to adopt an outside-in mindset that's guided by the voice of the customer. It realigns the organization to believe that they should understand the external customer's needs first and then work to solve them—rather than focusing internally and ideating around technology and solutions.

This is real customer-centricity.

By understanding the job map, your teams can focus on what will actually help the customer get the job done better—then go create and market these things.

No failing fast necessary.



TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY
THROUGH INNOVATION ↗

FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN ↗

BECOME A CLIENT ↗

3. Define a stable focal point for value creation.

Understanding your customer's job-to-be-done and job map offers a long-term focal point around which to create value. You may remember from [Chapter 1: What is Jobs-to-be-Done?](#), technologies and solutions change with time, but jobs remain stable over time.

Your goal for the foreseeable future is to help your customers get their job done better and cheaper.

This allows you to create long-term strategies against a stable unit of measure—a North Star to guide the business.

Jeff Bezos took this approach with building Amazon into the behemoth it is today. When he started the company two decades ago, he made it his mission to continually improve the consumer's buying experience—to make it better and better over time. And that's exactly what he has done. Amazon has created a platform that allows people to quickly and easily buy just about any product they could imagine, and the platform serves as the market standard for the type of buying experience consumers now expect.

The beauty of this approach is that there's no endpoint at which you have to scrap everything and come up with a new strategy. Once you have a clear understanding of your customer's entire job, you can make it your organization's mission to help people get that job done better and more cheaply—over decades.

Just like Amazon continues to do.



TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY
THROUGH INNOVATION ↗

FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN ↗

BECOME A CLIENT ↗

4. Get the entire job done to become the preferred solution.

In addition to adding value by helping your customer get the job done better and more cheaply, understanding the customer's job and job map also allows you to get more of the job done over time.

For many jobs, customers cobble together a variety of solutions to get through each job step—but in nearly every case, they'd prefer a single solution for the entire job.

When you visualize the entire job through the job map, it allows you to see:

- What pieces you're helping your customers get done
- What parts of the job your solutions fail to address (holes in your portfolio)
- What parts of the job your competitors are getting done

This is exactly the insight you need to determine how to become the solution-of-choice by helping your customer get the entire job done. Do you have a product with potential to get more of the job done? Focus on building this solution to address more job steps. On the other hand, if you have a solution that will never be able to address more of the job, it may be time to deprioritize investment.

This is exactly the insight you need to determine how to become the solution-of-choice by helping your customer get the entire job done. Do you have a product with potential to get more of the job done? Focus on building this solution to address more job steps. On the other hand, if you have a solution that will never be able to address more of the job, it may be time to deprioritize investment.

Consider the example of **Cox Automotive** ↗.

The brand's Auto division offers auto dealers SaaS solutions to better manage their inventory. They had been highly successful in the past, but they were no longer seeing the gains they needed to continue to grow market share. By getting a clear view of the customer's entire job, Cox Automotive identified significant gaps in the job map—and worked to fill them.

*"Jobs-to-be-Done helped us understand that our product was poorly positioned and failed to get important parts of the job done. They helped us identify and fill the gaps, which we accomplished with targeted development and M&A activity. **The project had a significant financial impact to the business.**"*

– RANDY KOBAT,
COX AUTOMOTIVE
VP & GENERAL MANAGER



TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY
THROUGH INNOVATION ↗

FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN ↗

BECOME A CLIENT ↗

5. Understand your true landscape to stay ahead of the competition.

In the same way Jobs-to-be-Done helps you identify holes in your own portfolio, it can help do the same thing for your competition.

There may be other brands that only get a few job steps done today. They don't overlap with your job steps, so you don't consider them a competitor.

But perhaps they're building their solution in a way that allows them to eventually get the entire job done on that single platform. You need to know this well in advance.

They're not a traditional competitor creating products that do what you do—but they are creating products that are helping customers get the entire job done. **In the long-term, they will be a threat.**



Build the ideal growth strategy

Dive deeper into how with **Tony Ulwick's book** *Jobs-to-be-Done: Theory to Practice*. ↗

JOBS TO BE DONE

THEORY TO PRACTICE

ANTHONY W. ULWICK

FOREWORD BY ALEX OSTERWALDER

"I call him the **Doming of Innovation** because, more than anyone else, Tony has turned innovation, into a science." -PHILIP KOTLER

Summary of Insights from Jobs-to-be-Done

- **Using Jobs-to-be-Done and the customer's job map offers a more efficient and reliable way to define and execute against your product roadmap** —and nail your next product launch. Your sole focus becomes figuring out how to help the customer get their job done better and/or more cheaply.
- **Jobs-to-be-Done helps marketers understand precisely what their customers want to align the entire organization around a clear and consistent messaging strategy** that speaks to the problem. Clarifying who the customer is and what the customer's needs are at each step of the job map leads to more effective marketing.
- **Executives can use JTBD to break down functional silos and align their teams.** Understanding the full job the job map aligns the organization around the steps the customer goes through to get that job done. This allows siloed teams to all view value creation in the same way — and begin rowing in the same direction.

Launch the next big thing

You made it through the entire Jobs-to-be-Done Playbook.

Nice work! You're one step closer to using JTBD to make a real impact on your business.



Want us to take over the heavy lifting of putting JTBD into practice? Set up a time to **talk to one of our innovation experts**, and we'll get everything moving for you.

TALK TO AN INNOVATION EXPERT



[TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY THROUGH INNOVATION ↗](#)

•

[FOLLOW US ON LINKEDIN ↗](#)

•

[BECOME A CLIENT ↗](#)

